RDG-P7 · PRÁCTICA 01

Multiple matching

Hoja 01 · Varias personas sobre un tema · dificultad 1 de 4

10 preguntas (44–53) · 4 secciones (A–D), que pueden repetirse · 1 punto por pregunta · tiempo orientativo: 18 minutos · sin consultar la teoría

You are going to read an article in which four novelists talk about writing their second book. For questions 44–53, choose from the novelists (**A–D**). The novelists may be chosen more than once. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

Which novelist

44 rejects a widely held assumption about second novels?

45 suggests that their early success owed something to circumstances?

46 credits another person with improving the second book?

47 describes a decision that they now regret?

48 had exhausted their own experience as a source of material?

49 has stopped paying attention to what critics say?

50 unexpectedly enjoyed a task they had been avoiding?

51 found relief from the novel in another kind of writing?

52 found a later book more demanding than the second?

53 feared that their reputation would not last?

The difficult second book

Four writers look back on what happened after a successful debut.

A Clare Hollis

When my first novel won a prize I had never expected even to be considered for, I was convinced that I had about eighteen months before the world forgot my name. My agent, who had seen this happen before, urged me to take a year off: to travel, to read, to do anything but write. I ignored her and started the next book the following Monday. It was a mistake, and one I would undo if I could. I spent a year producing two hundred pages that were competent, airless and entirely without purpose, and in the end I threw every one of them away. Looking back, I also think I took the prize far too much to heart. The judges liked the book, certainly, but it came out in a thin year for debuts, and against stronger competition it might well have sunk without trace. Knowing that has made me a good deal calmer about whatever comes next. The second novel, when it finally came, took three unhurried years and was the better for it.

B **Tomasz Brenner**

Journalists love the idea of the 'difficult second novel', and every interviewer asks me about it. I think it is largely a myth, or at least a story that tells us more about the publishing calendar than about writing. My second book was, if anything, easier than the first. I had learned how long a novel takes, where it is likely to stall and what to do when it does, and I no longer had to wonder whether I could finish one at all. Whatever pressure I felt came from my bank manager rather than from my readers. The book that nearly defeated me was the third, which I rewrote from scratch twice and which still feels to me like a house with the scaffolding left up. The second was reviewed less kindly than my debut; one critic said it read like the work of a man in a hurry. For a while I took comments like that to heart. These days I leave reviews unread, not out of pride but because I noticed that I had started writing for the critics rather than for my readers.

C **Ade Mensah**

My first novel came out when I was twenty-six, and for two years afterwards readers wrote to ask when the next one would appear. Every letter was kind, and every letter added a little to the weight I carried into my study each morning. The second book took seven years. For long stretches of them I wrote nothing but short stories, which asked nothing of me and which nobody was waiting for, and they were the only writing I enjoyed in that period. Friends assumed I had given up writing altogether, and for a while I let them think so. When I finally delivered a draft of the novel, my editor told me, very gently, that I had chosen the wrong narrator: the story belonged to his sister. I rewrote it from her point of view, a decision I have never regretted, and whatever is good in the finished book I owe to that conversation. It was by far the hardest thing I have written, and it remains the book I am proudest of.

D **Fiona Lockhart**

It is often said that first novels are disguised autobiography, and in my case that was simply true: almost everything in my debut had happened to me or to someone I knew. When I sat down to write the second, I found I had used my own life up; there was nothing left in it that I could bear to put on the page. The new book was set in a Victorian shipyard, and it demanded research, which I put off for months, telling myself that real novelists invent rather than look things up. In the end I had no choice, and to my astonishment I loved it: the archives, the old trade directories, the ledgers of a long-closed yard, which handed me the novel's best scene. Money was tight, since my advance had been modest, so I took on book reviewing for a newspaper to pay the bills. I still read every review of my own work, which my husband finds baffling. It is, I think, the better of my two books, though I doubt that many readers would agree.

Hoja de respuestas

Marca una sola letra por pregunta; la misma letra puede repetirse. Al corregir, 1 punto por acierto; los errores no restan. Anota también el tiempo empleado: el objetivo en el examen son unos 18 minutos.

Nº	A	B	C	D	Puntos
44	A	B	C	D	/ 1
45	A	B	C	D	/ 1
46	A	B	C	D	/ 1
47	A	B	C	D	/ 1
48	A	B	C	D	/ 1
49	A	B	C	D	/ 1
50	A	B	C	D	/ 1
51	A	B	C	D	/ 1
52	A	B	C	D	/ 1
53	A	B	C	D	/ 1
				Total	**/ 10**

Tiempo empleado: _____ minutos.

SOLUCIONES

1 punto por acierto. Cada solución da una línea del texto para cada elemento de la pregunta y, cuando hay una sección tentadora, explica por qué falla y de qué tipo es (los tipos de distractor de RDG-P5 §7). Los demás números de sección remiten a RDG-P7_Teoria_v1.

Clave rápida

Nº	Clave	Elementos	Tentadora	Teoría
44	**B**	1	D · medio cierto	§3.3 · §5.1
45	**A**	1	—	§3.3 · §4.2
46	**C**	1	A · no responde	§3.3 · §4.3
47	**A**	2	C · medio cierto	§4.1 · §3.4
48	**D**	1	A · ausente	§3.3 · §4.3
49	**B**	1	D · eco léxico	§3.4 · §4.2
50	**D**	2	C · lógica	§4.1 · §3.3
51	**C**	2	D · medio cierto	§4.1 · §4.3
52	**B**	1	C · eco léxico	§4.3 · §4.2
53	**A**	1	C · no responde	§3.3

Reparto de claves: A 3 · B 3 · C 2 · D 2. Cada sección es la respuesta de al menos una pregunta.

Explicación por pregunta

44 · B · Tomasz Brenner

Pregunta: Which novelist rejects a widely held assumption about second novels?

En el texto: La idea extendida la recoge (Journalists love the idea of the ‘difficult second novel’) y la rechaza: I think it is largely a myth.

Tentadora: D (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). También parte de una idea extendida sobre las primeras novelas (It is often said that first novels are disguised autobiography), pero para darle la razón: in my case that was simply true.

Teoría: §3.3 Prever la paráfrasis · §5.1 Varias personas sobre un tema

45 · A · Clare Hollis

Pregunta: Which novelist suggests that their early success owed something to circumstances?

En el texto: it came out in a thin year for debuts, and against stronger competition it might well have sunk without trace. El grado coincide con owed something: el libro tenía mérito (The judges liked the book, certainly), pero el momento ayudó.

Teoría: §3.3 Prever la paráfrasis · §4.2 Lo que se pierde al comprobar

46 · C · Ade Mensah

Pregunta: Which novelist credits another person with improving the second book?

En el texto: my editor told me, very gently, that I had chosen the wrong narrator; whatever is good in the finished book I owe to that conversation.

Tentadora: A (no responde, RDG-P5 §7.2). Aparece otra persona con un consejo (My agent, who had seen this happen before, urged me to take a year off), pero Hollis no lo siguió, así que no mejoró nada del libro.

Teoría: §3.3 Prever la paráfrasis · §4.3 La sección tentadora

47 · A · Clare Hollis

Pregunta: Which novelist describes a decision that they now regret?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. Decisión: I ignored her and started the next book the following Monday.
2. Arrepentimiento actual: It was a mistake, and one I would undo if I could.

Tentadora: C (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). Hay una decisión (reescribir la novela con otro narrador), pero con la polaridad contraria: a decision I have never regretted. Cumple el primer elemento y niega el segundo.

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §3.4 Señales de postura y de cambio

48 · D · Fiona Lockhart

Pregunta: Which novelist had exhausted their own experience as a source of material?

En el texto: I found I had used my own life up; there was nothing left in it that I could bear to put on the page.

Tentadora: A (ausente, RDG-P5 §7.7). Sus primeras páginas fracasaron (two hundred pages that were competent, airless and entirely without purpose), pero no dice que se le acabara el material: lo atribuye a haber empezado demasiado pronto. Hay que suponer la causa.

Teoría: §3.3 Prever la paráfrasis · §4.3 La sección tentadora

49 · B · Tomasz Brenner

Pregunta: Which novelist has stopped paying attention to what critics say?

En el texto: Antes sí (For a while I took comments like that to heart); ahora no: These days I leave reviews unread.

Tentadora: D (eco léxico, RDG-P5 §7.1). Habla de reseñas, pero para decir lo contrario: I still read every review of my own work.

Teoría: §3.4 Señales de postura y de cambio · §4.2 Lo que se pierde al comprobar

50 · D · Fiona Lockhart

Pregunta: Which novelist unexpectedly enjoyed a task they had been avoiding?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. Tarea evitada: it demanded research, which I put off for months.
2. Disfrute inesperado: to my astonishment I loved it.

Tentadora: C (lógica, RDG-P5 §7.5). Los dos elementos están, pero no recaen sobre la misma tarea: lo que evitaba era la novela, y lo que disfrutaba, los cuentos (they were the only writing I enjoyed in that period).

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §3.3 Prever la paráfrasis

51 · C · Ade Mensah

Pregunta: Which novelist found relief from the novel in another kind of writing?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. Otro tipo de escritura: I wrote nothing but short stories.
2. Como alivio: which asked nothing of me and which nobody was waiting for.

Tentadora: D (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). También escribe otra cosa, pero por dinero, no como alivio: I took on book reviewing for a newspaper to pay the bills.

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §4.3 La sección tentadora

52 · B · Tomasz Brenner

Pregunta: Which novelist found a later book more demanding than the second?

En el texto: The book that nearly defeated me was the third; además, My second book was, if anything, easier than the first.

Tentadora: C (eco léxico, RDG-P5 §7.1). Habla de dificultad, pero de la segunda novela, y en grado máximo: It was by far the hardest thing I have written. Ningún libro posterior la supera.

Teoría: §4.3 La sección tentadora · §4.2 Lo que se pierde al comprobar

53 · A · Clare Hollis

Pregunta: Which novelist feared that their reputation would not last?

En el texto: I was convinced that I had about eighteen months before the world forgot my name.

Tentadora: C (no responde, RDG-P5 §7.2). Siente presión, pero por las expectativas de los lectores, no por miedo a que lo olviden: every letter added a little to the weight I carried into my study each morning.

Teoría: §3.3 Prever la paráfrasis